A UNIVERSITY OF TWENTE THESIS LAYOUT

A Thesis You Can Make Your Own

A Guide to This Layout

Writing, Organising and Personalising a Doctoral Thesis

Marcio L. Lima de Oliveira

20XX

A THESIS YOU CAN MAKE YOUR OWN A GUIDE TO THIS LAYOUT

WRITING, ORGANISING AND PERSONALISING A DOCTORAL THESIS

Marcio L. Lima de Oliveira

A THESIS YOU CAN MAKE YOUR OWN A GUIDE TO THIS LAYOUT

WRITING, ORGANISING AND PERSONALISING A DOCTORAL THESIS

DOCTORAL THESIS

to obtain

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on the authority of the rector magnificus,

prof. dr. ir. A. Veldkamp,

on account of the decision of the Doctorate Board,

to be publicly defended

on Monday the XX of Month 20XX at XX:XX hours

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UNIVERSITY OF TWENTE.

For everyone who helped turn questions into understanding.

Acknowledgements

An acknowledgement is a personal part of a thesis. Use this page to thank the people whose advice, practical help and encouragement made your work possible. Begin with the research community if that suits your voice, then move towards friends and family. A sincere paragraph is often more effective than a long list.

For example: I thank my supervisors for helping me refine difficult questions, my colleagues for generous discussions, and my family for their patience and encouragement throughout this work.

Replace this example with your own words. Put contractual funding statements in the colophon or wherever your funder requires them; personal thanks do not replace those statements. This unnumbered chapter uses the quieter front-matter style.

Marcio L. Lima de Oliveira
Enschede, XX/XX/20XX

Abstract

A Thesis You Can Make Your Own A Guide to This Layout
Writing, Organising and Personalising a Doctoral Thesis

This example thesis explains how to use its own layout. Its chapters demonstrate the file organisation, university front matter, figures, tables, mathematical symbols, acronyms, citations and publication list. They also show how to adapt chapter colours, typography, page geometry and covers while preserving a consistent document structure.

Replace this text with a self-contained account of your research problem, approach, principal results and contribution. Define essential terminology and avoid references that force the reader to consult the rest of the thesis. The summary is independent of the short abstract boxes that open the chapters.

Samenvatting

Een proefschrift naar eigen inzicht
Handleiding voor het schrijven en vormgeven van een proefschrift

Dit voorbeeldproefschrift legt uit hoe de eigen opmaak werkt. De hoofdstukken behandelen de bestandsstructuur, het voorwerk, figuren, tabellen, wiskundige symbolen, afkortingen, literatuurverwijzingen en de publicatielijst. Ook laten ze zien hoe kleuren, lettertypen, pagina-afmetingen en de omslag kunnen worden aangepast zonder de samenhang van het document te verliezen.

Vervang deze tekst door een zelfstandige samenvatting van de onderzoeksvraag, de aanpak, de belangrijkste resultaten en de wetenschappelijke bijdrage. Gebruik de Nederlandse titel uit `ThesisDetails.tex`. Laat de vertaling controleren door iemand die zowel de taal als het vakgebied goed kent.

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1

Start with the structure

Abstract

This is a thesis layout whose example content is its user guide. Start here to build the document, find the files and replace the examples without reorganising your chapters.

1.1 A working document and a guide

Read the typeset examples beside their source. A bordered code listing shows what to type; the figure, equation or paragraph nearby shows how it is used. Listings are literal text, so a declaration shown in a listing does not define a command. The actual declarations live in the files named in the explanation.

The design uses the `memoir` class: coloured chapter openings, chapter markers on the page edges, running headings and circular page numbers. These are design choices. The university title pages have a separate role and are explained in chapter 2. This is a community template derived from a thesis, not an official university-issued class.

1.2 Build from the root folder

Use a recent full TeX Live or MiKTeX installation with `memoir` and the packages listed in `Configuration.tex`. TeX Live 2025 or later is the intended starting point. Select `main.tex` as the main document and pdfLaTeX as the engine. The bibliography backend is BibTeX, selected by `backend=bibtex` in the configuration.

```
pdflatex main.tex
```

```
bibtex main
pdflatex main.tex
pdflatex main.tex
```

Run pdfLaTeX again if it still requests a rerun. First-use pages, acronyms and the table of contents need information from previous runs. An empty symbol list on the first pass is expected. An alternative is `latexmk -pdf main.tex`, which manages the required passes. In an online editor, upload the whole folder, select `main.tex`, select pdfLaTeX and use its complete rebuild option after changing bibliography settings.

Build `propositions.tex` separately with pdfLaTeX. It reads the same personal details but produces a smaller, independent insert. It is not included in `main.tex`. Compilation commands are instructions for the reader; the distributed source review does not substitute for a build on your system.

1.3 Where each piece belongs

Table 1.1: The existing folder structure and its purpose.

Location	Purpose
`main.tex`	Reading order and document-level switches.
`ThesisDetails.tex`	Shared author, title, date, identifiers and cover paths.
`Configuration.tex`	Packages, page geometry, colours and styles.
`DeclareSymbols.tex`	Global symbol registry and your declarations.
`MathOperators.tex`	Mathematical operators and delimiter helpers.
`Chapters/Chapter_0`	Covers, title pages, acknowledgements and summaries.
`Chapters/Chapter_1` to `Chapter_8`	One main file per chapter.
`fig/` within each chapter	Figures owned by that chapter.
`Chapters/Chapter_Appendix`	Acronyms, symbols, notation and back cover.
`References/`	Separate reference and publication databases.
`tests/`	Source checks and an optional typesetting regression document.

1.4 Replace content in small steps

Start with `ThesisDetails.tex`; then replace the English and Dutch summaries, acknowledgements and chapter text. Keep figures in their chapter's `fig` folder. Empty figure directories contain a `.gitkeep` file so Git preserves them. Chapter

8 has no figure directory in the original tree; add one there only if you later need figures in that chapter.

Retain labels while you are drafting, or update every reference when renaming them. A consistent pattern such as `fig:ch3:earth`, `eq:linear` and `sec:acronyms` makes searches useful. Prefer `\autoref{...}` for named cross-references and `\eqref{...}` for parenthesised equation numbers. Do not type the resulting numbers by hand.

1.5 Source files and generated files

Share source files, bibliography databases, figure assets and their credits. Files such as `.aux`, `.log`, `.toc` and `.bbl` are build products. The included `.gitignore` excludes these products while allowing PDF figures in the chapter directories. It does not ignore every PDF. The old local copies of standard `.sty` packages are not bundled; the template uses the maintained copies in the TeX distribution.

2

Personal details and university pages

Abstract

Set the shared metadata once, then personalise the front matter. The four section files in this chapter demonstrate how a long chapter can be split into smaller source files.

2.1 One source for personal details

Both entry points read `ThesisDetails.tex`. The names are fictional, the year is `20XX`, the date is `XX/XX/20XX`, and the ISBN fields use `XXX-XX-XXX-XXXX-X`. These examples are meant to look like book metadata without pretending to be assigned identifiers. Replace both print and digital ISBNs with the identifiers issued for your actual editions.

```
\MyThesis[A Thesis You Can Make Your Own]
{A Guide to This Layout}
{Writing, Organising and Personalising a Doctoral Thesis}
{Alex Morgan}{A.~Morgan}{20XX}
\MyDefense[Monday]{XX}{Month}{XX:XX}
```

The optional argument of `\MyThesis` is the first title line. Its five mandatory arguments are the second title line, subtitle, full name, short name and year. The optional argument of `\MyDefense` is the weekday; its three mandatory arguments are day, month and time. These setters create commands, so call each only once. Edit their existing calls rather than adding another.

The setters create these commands:

```
\thesistitleA      \thesistitleB      \thesissubtitle
\thesisauthor      \thesisauthorshort \thesisyear
\defenseweekday    \defenseday        \defensemonth
\defensetime
```

The combined `\thesistitle` is used on formal pages and in PDF metadata. The separate `\defensedate` is a short display date: keep it consistent with the expanded date fields. Tildes between initials and surnames prevent unhelpful line breaks. Escape special characters in metadata, for example `Research \& Design`.

The Dutch title and subtitle, supervisors, committee chair, printer and group also have named fields in this file. Committee member rows remain in `Title_Preamb.tex`, where their number can be changed naturally.

2.2 Preserve the university front matter

The formal pages follow Annex 3 of the University of Twente Doctoral Regulations effective 1 January 2026 [Uni26a]. The model uses an uppercase title, "DOCTORAL THESIS", an approval page and a manuscript committee page; it omits birth details. The rector's name follows that model. Confirm the final wording, names and pages with the Doctorate Board Support Office before printing.

Article 13 requires Dutch and English titles and abstracts; both are provided in `Abstract.tex`. Article 19 requires title-page approval before copies are made. The 2026 Doctorate workflow includes this approval [Uni26b].

`Title_Preamb.tex` keeps the cover, half-title, blank reverse, formal title page, approval/colophon, committee and optional dedication together. The approval page follows the concrete Annex 3 model, including the credits and identifiers shown there. Article 15 describes a narrower set of permitted reverse-page material; have the Support Office resolve any requested variation.

Change the metadata and committee entries, not the formal degree wording to match a decorative theme. Use the actual number of supervisors and the correct singular or plural role headings. The example committee is not a prescription for committee membership. Joint doctorates need the applicable agreed model.

2.3 Separate presentation from required content

The teal palette, sans-serif body, chapter tabs, 170 by 240 mm trim size and optional dedication are this layout's choices. They are not presented as university requirements. chapter 6 explains how to change them. Funding and affiliation

examples are fictional; replace them with accurate statements. The UT logo is retained as a separate asset, not redrawn or recoloured. Institutional identity rules apply to its use.

2.4 Summaries, acknowledgements and declarations

Edit `Abstract.tex` to replace both summaries. It uses an `otherlanguage` environment for Dutch and returns to English afterwards. Both summaries are unnumbered chapters with explicit table-of-contents entries. The short chapter summaries use `absbox`; they serve a different purpose.

```
\chapter*{Acknowledgements}
\addcontentsline{toc}{chapter}{Acknowledgements}
Write your acknowledgements here.
```

The title and table-of-contents text should agree. This pattern is also used for the back-matter lists. Remove the optional dedication as a whole page block, including its page break, to avoid leaving an accidental blank page.

Annex 4 describes the author's declaration for the draft submitted to the manuscript committee, including contributions and AI use [Uni26a]. Prepare it for your actual work; the example content here is not a declaration of research authorship. Keep submission attachments distinct from the final book unless instructed otherwise.

2.5 Why these section filenames are familiar

This chapter retains four section files whose contents now explain the template:

- `Section_Radar.tex`
- `Section_DetEst.tex`
- `Section_Deep_Learning.tex`
- `Section_Metrics.tex`

The names preserve the original layout of the source tree; filenames do not determine the printed headings. You can rename a section file later by updating its corresponding `\input` in `Chapter_02.tex`.

2.6 The separate propositions insert

The file `propositions.tex` shares the thesis metadata and uses its own 148 by 210 mm trim area with 3 mm bleed. It has no chapter tabs or cover image.

Its statements are examples about writing and methods; replace them with your own defensible propositions.

Article 16 permits an optional loose insert of at most ten propositions: at least four thesis-related and at most two general, with the rest academic. Promotor approval is required [Uni26a]. The example contains eight items grouped accordingly, but their illustrative content is not an approved set.

```
\begin{enumerate}[itemsep=5pt]
  \item A proposition supported by the thesis. (This thesis)
  \item Another proposition, expressed as a defensible claim.
\end{enumerate}
```

Do not copy an entire `document` environment into a chapter. The insert is a separate document, so open or compile it as its own entry point.

3

Figures, tables and algorithms

Abstract

Keep assets beside their chapter, cite their origin and show enough information for readers to understand them. These examples demonstrate photographs, subfigures, tables, diagrams and pseudocode.

3.1 A figure stored with its chapter

Every chapter sets `\FigLocation` before its figures. Use a filename with an explicit extension and a width relative to the current line, especially inside a narrow box or subfigure. Figure 3.1 uses a downloaded NASA Apollo 17 photograph, stored in this chapter's `fig` directory.

```
\renewcommand{\FigLocation}{Chapters/Chapter_3/fig/}
\begin{figure}[htbp]
  \centering
  \includegraphics[width=0.52\linewidth]
    {\FigLocation earth-apollo17.jpg}
  \caption[Short list entry]{A descriptive caption and credit.}
  \label{fig:ch3:earth}
\end{figure}
```

Place `\label` after `\caption` so it records the figure number. The optional caption supplies a shorter list-of-figures entry. The placement letters permit a figure here, at the top, at the bottom, or on a float page. They are preferences, not fixed positions. Use `\clearpage` at a deliberate boundary to flush waiting floats instead of repeatedly forcing placement.



Figure 3.1: Earth from Apollo 17. Credit: NASA/Apollo 17 crew, 7 December 1972; public-domain image obtained through Wikimedia Commons. Source and download details are in `fig/ATTRIBUTION.txt`.

3.2 Compare panels without creating a new asset

The existing layout loads `subfig`. Use `\subfloat` from that package; do not also load `subcaption`. The second panel below crops the same image at typesetting time. This is a layout demonstration, not a new observation.



(a) Full photograph



(b) Central crop

Figure 3.2: A full image and a crop of the same NASA/Apollo 17 photograph. Credit and public-domain source as in Figure 3.1.

```
\subfloat[Full photograph]{\includegraphics[width=.39\linewidth]
  {\FigLocation earth-apollo17.jpg}}
\hfill
\subfloat[Central crop]{\includegraphics[width=.39\linewidth,
  trim=30mm 30mm 30mm 30mm,clip]{\FigLocation earth-apollo17.jpg}}
```

The trim order is left, bottom, right, top; unitless values are big points. This example uses explicit millimetres. Keep the total crop smaller than the image's natural dimensions, which depend on its resolution metadata. Always state when a crop, contrast adjustment or annotation changes how an image is presented. Keep the original asset and its attribution with the chapter.

3.3 Tables with readable precision

Table 3.1 contains invented data, solely to demonstrate a table. `booktabs` supplies the horizontal rules; `siunitx` supplies the `S` column that aligns decimal values. Put units in column headings.

Table 3.1: Illustrative measurements; these are not research results.

Method	Time (s)	Error (a.u.)
Baseline	12.4	0.32
Alternative	10.8	0.28
Reference	15.0	0.25

```
\begin{tabular}{@{}l S[table-format=2.1]@{}}
  \toprule
  Method & {Time (s)} \\
  \midrule
  Baseline & 12.4 \\
  \bottomrule
\end{tabular}
```

Use `tabularx` for wrapping text columns, `longtable` for a table that can break over pages, and `multirow` only when a shared row heading actually helps. A `longtable` is not placed inside a `table` float. Avoid shrinking a wide table until the letters become unreadable.



Figure 3.3: A small vector diagram drawn with TikZ and the current chapter colour.

3.4 Editable diagrams

For a diagram this small, its TikZ source can remain in the chapter. Larger diagram sources can live in the same `fig` directory and be included with `\input{\FigLocation workflow.tex}`. PDF is suitable for exported vector artwork; PNG and JPEG are suitable for raster images. No EPS conversion or shell escape is needed for the examples in this template.

3.5 Pseudocode and ordinary footnotes

Algorithm 1 Mean of a nonempty sequence

Require: Values $u_1, \ldots, u_n$ with $n > 0$
Ensure: Arithmetic mean m
1: $s \leftarrow 0$
2: **for** $i = 1, \ldots, n$ **do**
3: $\quad s \leftarrow s + u_i$
4: **end for**
5: ▷ Normalise only after accumulating the observations.
6: $m \leftarrow s/n$
7: **return** m

`algorithm` supplies the floating caption; `algorithmic` supplies the pseudocode. The configuration adds `\LineComment{text}` as a full-line comment. Refer to it with `\autoref{alg:mean}`, as in Algorithm 1. Use `\myfootnote{text}` for an ordinary numbered footnote.[1] Publication-origin notes use a separate helper introduced in chapter 5.

[1] This is a normal footnote; its helper has the same argument as `\footnote`.

4

Symbols, equations and acronyms

Abstract

Declare notation centrally and introduce it where the explanation reads naturally. The global list of symbols and the abbreviation list use first-use information across the whole thesis.

4.1 Declare a command before using it

Add a symbol to `DeclareSymbols.tex`, below the registry implementation. Choose a descriptive command name containing letters; do not overwrite a standard command such as `\alpha` or `\epsilon`.

```
\DeclareThesisSymbol{sampleInput}{x}{Input value}
\DeclareThesisSymbol{sampleOutput}{y}{Output value}
\DeclareThesisSymbol{sampleSlope}{a}{Linear model coefficient}
\DeclareThesisSymbol{sampleOffset}{b}{Linear model offset}
```

These declarations already exist in the supplied file. Once registered, `\sampleInput` can be used in text or maths. A declaration in the preamble is a programming step; the explanation of that variable in your prose may come before or after its first equation. An undefined command still cannot be used before it has been registered with TeX.

4.2 First appearances inside an equation

The next equation deliberately uses four registered symbols for the first time:

$$y = ax + b. \tag{4.1}$$

Here x is the input, y is the output, a is the slope and b is the offset. These explanations follow the equation by choice. Each symbol links to the global list, and its list entry links back to the first typeset occurrence recorded on a shipped page.

```
\begin{equation}
  \sampleOutput = \sampleSlope\sampleInput + \sampleOffset.
  \label{eq:linear}
\end{equation}
Here \sampleInput\ is the input and \sampleOutput\ is the output.
```

Use an ordinary equation label alongside the symbol commands. Symbol tracking does not require a `\label` for each variable. The historical interface `\mathsymbols{4}{sampleInput}{x}{Input value}` also works when used *instead of* the corresponding new declaration. Its chapter argument is ignored: the list is global and follows declaration order, not chapter order or alphabetical order. Register each command once.

4.3 Aligned equations, vectors and delimiters

$$\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_N)^{\mathsf{T}}, \tag{4.2}$$

$$\varepsilon = \|\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}\|_2. \tag{4.3}$$

The example in (4.3) assumes a compatible square matrix; its purpose is to show typography. The dimension notation is explained here after the display: N is the number of observations, $\mathbf{x}$ is the observation vector, $\mathbf{A}$ is a linear transformation and ε is the residual magnitude.

```
\norm{x}{2}          % automatically sized norm, with subscript 2
\norm{x}{}           % norm without a subscript
\norm[\big]{x}{2}    % explicit delimiter size
\Abs{u-v}           % automatically sized absolute value
\Abs[\Big]{u-v}     % explicit size
\Set{x}{x>0}        % fixed-size set braces by default
\Set[\Big]{x}{x>0}  % larger set braces
\func{f}{X}{Y}      % f : X -> Y
```

An optional size is useful in multi-line displays because a `\left` delimiter cannot be opened on one alignment row and closed on another. The legacy norm always takes two mandatory arguments, including an empty second argument when no subscript is wanted. Do not write `\norm{x}`.

$$f\colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}, \qquad f(x) = |x|, \qquad X = \{x \in \mathbb{R} \,|\, x > 0\}.$$

`MathOperators.tex` also provides upright operators such as `\argmin`, `\argmax`, `\diag` and `\Tr`. The notation appendix lists the full helper vocabulary. Use `\mathrm{d}` for a differential and a consistent vector convention throughout the thesis.

4.4 What the list records

Only used registered symbols appear in the list. The declared `\unusedExample` is deliberately never executed and should be absent. Plain letters such as `x` in an equation are ordinary maths, not tracked symbols. A code listing does not count as a use. Table-of-contents replays, glossary rows and temporary equation measurements do not create first-use records. Float placement can affect which page is first, so let references stabilise after changing figures or captions.

The list reflects the previous complete compilation. Rebuild the complete thesis after deleting uses or working with `\includeonly`. There is no separate formal-definition command: the default keeps the existing first-use behaviour. Avoid symbols in headings when plain words are clearer. If a heading needs mathematics, supply readable bookmark text:

```
\section{Behaviour of \texorpdfstring{$\sampleInput$}{the input}}
```

4.5 Define and use acronyms

Define abbreviations in `Chapters/Chapter_Appendix/Acronyms.tex`:

```
\begin{acronym}[NASA]
  \acro{UT}{University of Twente}
  \acro{PDF}{Portable Document Format}
  \acro{API}{application programming interface}
\end{acronym}
```

The optional `NASA` specifies the width reserved for the short forms; choose the widest abbreviation in your own list. Definitions located in the back matter

become available to earlier pages through auxiliary files, so an initial run may show unresolved acronyms. Complete the usual rebuild sequence.

The first `\ac{UT}` produces University of Twente (UT); the next produces UT. For another example, application programming interface (API) becomes API on later use. The main commands are:

`\ac{key}` Full form on first use, short form afterwards.
`\acs{key}` Short form, such as PDF.
`\acl{key}` Long form, such as Portable Document Format.
`\acf{key}` Full form regardless of earlier use.
`\acp{key}` Plural, with the same first-use convention.
`\ac*{key}` An untracked use; a star is also available on the explicit short, long and full forms.

For irregular plurals add `\acroplural{key}[short plural]{long plural}`. For example the sample `API` definition provides APIs. The options `printonlyused` and `withpage` select a global list of used abbreviations with page information. `\acreset{key}` or `\acresetall` resets first-use expansion if you intentionally want a fresh introduction; the template does not reset the list at every chapter. Remove `printonlyused` only if you want unused definitions printed too.

4.6 Theorems, definitions and propositions

Definition 4.6.1 (Nonnegative input)

An input is nonnegative when $x \geq 0$.

Theorem 4.6.1 (Nonnegative square)

For every real number x, $x^2 \geq 0$.

Proof. If $x \geq 0$, the product $x \cdot x$ is nonnegative. If $x < 0$, it is the product of two negative numbers and is positive. □

Proposition 4.6.1 (Equality case)

A real number satisfies $x^2 = 0$ if and only if $x = 0$.

```
\begin{theorem}{Nonnegative square}{square}
  For every real number $x$, $x^2\geq 0$.
\end{theorem}
Theorem~\ref{thrm:square}
```

These boxed environments take a title and a label suffix. Their automatic prefixes are `thrm:`, `def:` and `prop:`; the suffix alone is not a complete reference. They are numbered within sections. The `definition` box can break across pages; keep the other two short or add `breakable` to their `newtcbtheorem` styles when needed. The boxed mathematical proposition is independent of the propositions insert.

5

References and your publications

Abstract

Maintain two databases with different purposes. References record the literature consulted; publications record the author's own output. A keyword determines which printed list receives an entry.

5.1 Two files, two roles

Put external literature in `References/references.bib` and your own publications in `References/publications.bib`. Both files are loaded by `main.tex`. Every entry intended for the Publications list needs `keywords = {mypub}`. The database filename alone does not select the printed list.

```
@article{morganExample,
  author       = {Morgan, Alex and Taylor, Jordan},
  title        = {An Example Publication for This Template},
  journaltitle = {Example Journal},
  year         = {2026},
  volume       = {1},
  pages        = {1--8},
  keywords     = {mypub},
  note         = {Fictional example; replace before submission}
}
```

This chapter illustrates a publication-origin note. The accompanying entry [MT26] is fictional and demonstrates formatting only.

The real documentation references are separated from these fictional entries. For example, the `memoir` manual [Theb] is consulted literature, while [MT26] is an illustrative author publication. Do not duplicate the same entry key across the two databases.

5.2 Printing the lists

The end of `main.tex` uses the original keyword distinction:

```
\printbibliography[notkeyword=mypub,heading=bibintoc]
\printbibliography[keyword=mypub,title={Publications},
  heading=bibintoc]
```

`heading=bibintoc` adds each heading to the table of contents. The alphabetic citation labels are shared across the document; the split changes membership, not the identity of a cited item. The default style is `alphabetic`, not an IEEE bibliography style.

Only cited entries normally print. To include a particular publication that is not cited in the prose, use an explicit key:

```
\nocite{morganSupplement}
```

Avoid `\nocite{*}` unless you really want every entry from both databases. An own-publication entry without `mypub` will appear in the literature list; an external reference with that keyword will appear under Publications.

5.3 Citations and publication notes

Use `\cite{key}` for a normal citation, `\textcite{key}` when the author belongs in the sentence, and `\parencite{key}` for the style's parenthetical form. An optional locator can be useful, for example `\cite[Chapter 3]{memoirManual}`. Citation commands inside the literal listings do not count as citations.

The existing `\pubfootnote{text}` helper inserts an unnumbered footnote without advancing the ordinary footnote counter. Place it directly after a chapter heading or its opening abstract when giving a paper's origin:

```
\pubfootnote{Parts of this chapter are based on
  \cite{morganExample}.}
```

Use accurate wording for an adapted or reproduced paper, include the coauthors where appropriate, and retain any required publisher credit. The note is not a

substitute for a bibliography entry. Ordinary notes use `\myfootnote{text}` or `\footnote{text}`.

5.4 Changing the citation style deliberately

The `biblatex` options are in `Configuration.tex`. For numeric citations change `style=alphabetic` to `style=numeric`; keep the keyword filters. The `url`, `doi` and `isbn` options control those fields in bibliography entries, not the identifiers on the title pages. `backref=true` adds citing-page information. The sample online references include their access links in `howpublished` because URLs are disabled by the inherited bibliography options.

If you switch to `backend=biber`, use Biber rather than BibTeX and rebuild from clean auxiliary files. Change the tool and the option together. The `biblatex` manual [Thea] describes the richer styles and data model. Keep a single bibliography system; do not add `natbib` or a separate `\bibliographystyle` command on top of this setup.

6

Make the design your own

Abstract

The original visual language is retained: chapter colours, edge markers, circular page numbers and a compact book size. This chapter gives specific recipes for adapting each part.

6.1 Where to make a change

Use the end of `ThesisDetails.tex` for small personal overrides after the base configuration has loaded. Edit `Configuration.tex` when changing package options or the implementation of a style. Make one visible change at a time, rebuild, and inspect a chapter opening, an ordinary left/right page, a figure page and the back matter. Those pages exercise different parts of the design.

6.2 Chapter colours

`\ThumbColor{index}` chooses the main chapter colour and `\absColor{index}` chooses its companion tint. The index is zero-based: index 0 corresponds to Chapter 1, index 1 to Chapter 2, and so on. The default eight-colour sequence moves from teal through cadet blue, grey blue, marine blue, sky blue and cornflower blue to Egyptian blue and blue.

Each numbered chapter opening advances the `chapCnt` counter. `\ColorTheme` reads the current main colour; `\NumberChapterColor` selects the colour needed while the next chapter number is being drawn. `\SectionColor` mixes the theme with black for readability. Do not advance `chapCnt` manually inside an ordinary chapter.

Here is a complete two-colour recipe. It makes Chapter 1 green, Chapter 2 plum and later chapters green. Extend both case lists to assign more colours:

```
% Add at the end of ThesisDetails.tex.
\definecolor{Forest}{HTML}{245B47}
\definecolor{Plum}{HTML}{603F65}
\renewcommand{\ThumbColor}[1]{%
  \ifcase #1 Forest\or Plum\else Forest\fi}
\renewcommand{\absColor}[1]{%
  \ifcase #1 Forest!15!white\or Plum!15!white%
  \else Forest!15!white\fi}
\renewcommand{\HeadingColor}{Forest}
\renewcommand{\TitleColor}{Forest!70!black}
```

The colour `Forest!15!white` contains 15 percent Forest and 85 percent white. The abstract box applies its own further tint, so adjust its `colback` setting if your chosen colour becomes too faint. `\ColorDarkTeal` and the other `Color...` commands are aliases for the named palette; changing an alias changes every place that uses it. `\HeadingColor` and `\TitleColor` serve nonchapter accents. The default front and back covers use `LightTeal2` and `DarkTeal` directly, so update those definitions or the cover files for a matching cover.

For a single-colour book, set both selectors to a fixed colour:

```
\renewcommand{\ThumbColor}[1]{black!75}
\renewcommand{\absColor}[1]{black!10}
\renewcommand{\SectionColor}{black}
\hypersetup{hidelinks}
```

This changes chapter accents and links. The covers and theorem boxes have their own colours; change those as well if the entire book must be monochrome.

6.3 Edge markers and page numbers

The edge markers are drawn by `\lthumb` and `\rthumb`. The template adds one switch, `\ThesisThumbsfalse`, to hide them while keeping the rest of the page style. `\ThesisThumbstrue` enables them again. The `notationstyle` page style already omits the markers and is used for front and back matter.

`\thumbheight` controls marker height, `\thumbedge` its edge offset, `\thumbhspace` its horizontal extent, and `\thumbvspace` the spacing between marker positions. If you change the number of chapters, update the palette and recompute the spacing together:

```
\renewcommand{\ThesisChapterCount}{6}
```

```
\setlength\thumbvspace{%
  (\textheight - 1cm - \thumbheight/2)/\ThesisChapterCount}
```

The count reserves marker positions; it does not include or exclude chapters. Change the `\include` commands in `main.tex` separately. Use a positive integer. For a large number of chapters, reduce the marker height or disable markers so they do not overlap.

`\PageNumberStyle` defines the TikZ node named `0` used in the footer. Preserve that node name because the surrounding picture uses its baseline. `\minsize` sets its minimum size, `\myfontsize` the number font size and `\myfontconfig` the shared font/weight.

```
\renewcommand{\PageNumberStyle}{%
  \node(0)[draw=\ColorTheme,rounded corners=2pt,
    minimum size=\minsize,fill=white]
    {\textcolor{black}{\myfontconfig\myfontsize\thepage}}}
```

This replaces the circle with a rounded box. The caller supplies the terminating TikZ semicolon; do not add a second standalone drawing command outside the node.

6.4 Fonts and headings

The inherited body is sans serif. For a serif body and serif headings, add:

```
\renewcommand{\familydefault}{\rmdefault}
\renewcommand{\myfont}{\rmfamily}
```

Changing only `\familydefault` affects the body while the explicit `\myfont` helper can keep headings sans serif. The supplied Latin Modern fonts support the pdfLaTeX setup. Installing a different font package is a separate choice; switching to system fonts requires an engine and font setup designed for LuaLaTeX or XeLaTeX.

The `thesis` chapter style controls the chapter-number tile, title alignment and space before/after the heading. Its `beforechapskip`, `midchapskip` and `afterchapskip` lengths are in `Configuration.tex`. Sections and subsections use `\titleformat`. Adjust their `\fontsize{size}{baseline}` values and colour together; keep a positive baseline if you expect a heading to wrap onto several lines. The `\chaptermark` and `\sectionmark` definitions set running-head text. A short optional chapter title can help long headings:

```
\chapter[Short running title]{A Longer Descriptive Chapter Title}
```

6.5 Paper size, trim and margins

The original geometry is retained: 176 by 246 mm paper, a 170 by 240 mm layout and a 3 mm offset on each side. That provides a 3 mm bleed area. The inherited binding offset is -3 mm; confirm this and the inner margin with your printer. The page dimensions are a design decision, not a universal UT requirement. The configuration synchronises `memoir`'s physical stock size with the final `geometry` paper dimensions immediately before the document begins. Keep that hook: otherwise the class can export a Letter-size PDF even though the text and cover use the smaller thesis dimensions.

For an untrimmed A4 digital draft, put a complete geometry override after the configuration, including the layout and offset inherited from the print setup:

```
\geometry{papersize={210mm,297mm},layoutsize={210mm,297mm},
  layoutoffset={0mm,0mm},bindingoffset=0mm,
  inner=30mm,outer=25mm,top=25mm,bottom=25mm}
\setlength\thumbvspace{%
  (\textheight - 1cm - \thumbheight/2)/\ThesisChapterCount}
```

Changing only the paper size would leave the smaller trim layout in place. After changing geometry, review marker placement and cover text widths too. The propositions entry point has a later geometry override of its own.

6.6 Covers and boxes

The default covers are editable TikZ artwork in `Cover.tex` and `BackCover.tex`. To use complete cover artwork, set the two paths in `ThesisDetails.tex`:

```
\renewcommand{\coverlocation}{Chapters/Chapter_0/fig/cover.pdf}
\renewcommand{\backcoverlocation}{%
  Chapters/Chapter_Appendix/fig/backcover.pdf}
```

Leave a path empty to use the corresponding built-in design. The artwork replaces the whole page, so include the title and author in an imported cover. Supply artwork with the same aspect ratio and bleed as the paper; the full-page inclusion specifies both dimensions. A printer's full spread with spine is a different deliverable from these individual front/back pages.

The `absbox` environment uses the current chapter tint. Give one box a different heading with `\begin{absbox}[title={Chapter overview}]`. Change its `newtcolorbox` definition for a global adjustment. The theorem and proposition boxes use `LightTeal2`; definition boxes use `PinkNude`. Their `coltitle`, `colbacktitle` and `colback` keys are independent of the chapter palette.

7

Extend and maintain the layout

Abstract

Keep structural changes local and predictable. This chapter explains document divisions, partial builds, the package responsibilities and the custom commands that connect the layout.

7.1 Chapters and section files

An ordinary chapter begins with this pattern:

```
\chapter{A Descriptive Title}\label{chap:example}
\renewcommand{\FigLocation}{Chapters/Chapter_3/fig/}
\renewcommand{\ChapLocation}{Chapters/Chapter_3/}
\begin{absbox}
  A short account of this chapter's purpose and contribution.
\end{absbox}
\section{The first section}
```

`\FigLocation` is a convenience prefix for graphics; `\ChapLocation` is a prefix for section files. They are ordinary macros, not a change of working directory. Relative paths still resolve from the root where `main.tex` is compiled. Reassign them in each chapter rather than relying on whichever chapter happened to run before it.

`\include` gives each chapter its own auxiliary file and starts a new page. `\input` inserts a smaller file without those chapter-level page boundaries. Keep `\include` calls in `main.tex` and use `\input` for sections. The original four section files in Chapter 2 demonstrate that distinction.

7.2 Partial builds and back matter

Use `\includeonly{Chapters/Chapter_3/Chapter_03}` in the preamble for a drafting shortcut. Build the complete thesis first so omitted chapters have auxiliary records, and build it completely again before checking lists and citations. The custom colour counter and symbol-use state are not a guarantee of final output in a partial build; do not judge first-use pages from one.

`\frontmatter` uses front-matter numbering; `\mainmatter` starts numbered chapters; `\backmatter` suppresses chapter numbering again. The list of symbols is printed by `\PrintThesisSymbols` inside `MathSymbols.tex`. Keep the label `ch:listofsymbols` there: symbol hyperlinks target that label. `\ThesisSymbolRecord` and `\ThesisUntrackedAcronyms` are supporting registry commands, not commands to insert into normal prose. The former reads auxiliary records; the latter prevents glossary descriptions from changing acronym first-use state.

To add a numbered appendix, put its source inside the existing `Chapter_Appendix` directory and add it before `\backmatter`:

```
\appendix
\include{Chapters/Chapter_Appendix/AdditionalMethods}
\backmatter
```

Its file begins with `\chapter{Additional methods}`. Numbered appendices also exercise the chapter style, so extend the marker count/palette or disable markers for that part. The existing abbreviation and notation files are unnumbered back-matter chapters and do not require `\appendix`.

7.3 Package responsibilities

Load packages once in the preamble. The groups below help locate a setting without treating every package's internal commands as part of this template.

Page and text design `memoir`, `geometry`, `titlesec`, `microtype`, `fontenc`, `lmodern`, `setspace` and `footmisc` provide the book structure, dimensions, fonts and spacing.

Colour and graphics `xcolor`, `graphicx`, `tikz`, `tcolorbox`, `subfig`, `wrapfig` and `pdfpages` support artwork, boxes and imported pages. `circuitikz` is available for circuit diagrams; its `siunitx` option supplies the unit tools used here. The inherited `background` package is neutralised by an empty background; the example covers explicitly draw their own page overlays.

Mathematics `amsmath`, `amsthm`, `amssymb` and `mathtools` support displays, proofs, symbols and paired delimiters.

Tables and lists `booktabs`, `tabularx`, `longtable`, `multirow`, `colortbl`, `multicol` and `enumitem` provide rules, wrapping columns, multipage tables and list controls. `varwidth` and `minibox` support compact text boxes.

Language and references `babel`, `csquotes`, `acronym`, `biblatex` and `hyperref` handle language, quotations, abbreviation state, citations and links. Only Dutch and English are enabled in this template. `alphabeta` supports Greek letters in text.

Code and algorithms `listings` prints literal source examples; `algorithm`, `algorithmicx` and `algpseudocode` provide the pseudocode example. `ifthen` selects optional cover artwork; `intcalc` supports integer arithmetic in inherited design code.

The inherited `lipsum` and `breakcites` dependencies are not needed for these examples and have been omitted. Consult the class and package manuals before adding another package that manages the same captions, chapter styles or bibliography. The template does not need a shell-escape-enabled build.

7.4 Keep links and first-use state understandable

`\hypersetup` controls PDF metadata and link colours. The configuration sets acronym links black through public font hooks; the symbol commands also use black links. Setting `linkcolor` therefore changes ordinary cross-references without recolouring every tracked symbol or abbreviation. The wrappers preserve the acronym package's fonts through three command copies:

```
\ThesisOriginalAcsFont
\ThesisOriginalAcfFont
\ThesisOriginalAcfsFont
```

Leave these copies intact when only changing a palette.

Use meaningful text in bookmarks, avoid fragile formatting in captions, and give figures a short list entry when the full caption is long. Cross-references are records built across runs, not values calculated correctly in every first pass. After changing a bibliography backend or moving many labels, rebuild the document's auxiliary files through your editor's clean/recompile operation.

8

From example to your thesis

Abstract

Replace the instructional content gradually, verify the complete document and prepare a clean source release. The structure can stay familiar while the writing and design become your own.

8.1 A practical order of work

1. Edit `ThesisDetails.tex`: titles in both languages, author, date, supervisors, identifiers and affiliation. Keep the real rector details required for your defence rather than substituting an invented office holder.
2. Update committee rows and funding in `Title_Preamb.tex`; replace the summaries and acknowledgements. Remove the dedication if unwanted.
3. Replace chapter text and chapter abstracts while keeping the folders and their figure locations. Add your actual references and publications to the appropriate databases.
4. Declare your symbols and acronyms centrally. Remove unused example declarations once their role is clear; do not remove the registry implementation.
5. Choose a palette, font and cover design, then check their effect on every page style. Confirm the print geometry with your printer.
6. Replace or remove the illustrative propositions and obtain the required approvals for the real thesis and its formal pages.

8.2 Checks after a complete build

Read the log for undefined commands, missing files, unresolved citations, duplicate destinations and rerun requests. Investigate overfull boxes rather than assuming they are harmless. Check that figures and captions remain legible at the final trim size, tables do not run into margins and long headings fit.

Follow a symbol link to the global list and its page link back to the first occurrence. Confirm that an unused declaration stays out of the list, that abbreviations expand as intended, and that your publication entries appear only in Publications. Check the table of contents after the final pagination pass. The small source checker in `tests` catches several structural mistakes, but it cannot verify typography or actual PDF destinations.

8.3 Remove example identity and data

Search for Alex Morgan, Example Press, Example University, fictional publication titles, `20XX`, the placeholder ISBN pattern and the template's chapter titles. Replace the actual content fields; keep explanatory occurrences only if you are distributing this guide itself. Do not copy the sample results table or methodological claims into a real thesis as research findings.

The NASA photograph includes a credit file. Keep that file if you keep the image; for other images, record the creator, original source and reuse terms. The UT logo retains its institutional identity status. References and sample publications are distinct even when both appear near the end of the book.

8.4 Share a clean template repository

Publish the contents of the template folder as the repository root. Keep `Chapters`, each existing `fig` directory, `References` and `tests` in their current locations. The repository README gives a short entry point; the thesis chapters provide the detailed examples. A released example PDF can be useful after a successful build, but it is a generated deliverable, not the source of the layout.

The inherited source attributes layout work to Márcio Luiz Lima de Oliveira and V. el Hakim. The template source and documentation are distributed under the LaTeX Project Public License, version 1.3c. Preserve the credits and follow the licence conditions when sharing modifications. `LICENSE` contains the complete licence, and `MANIFEST.txt` lists the covered files. The sample book's copyright paragraph describes the example thesis; `LICENSING.txt` explains the separate status of university wording, the photograph and the logo.

For future changes, describe the affected user-facing behaviour and verify the smallest relevant example. Update this guide when adding a public helper so the example document remains the explanation of its own layout.

Abbreviations

UT University of Twente 16
PDF Portable Document Format 16
API application programming interface 16

List of Symbols

x	Input value	14
y	Output value	14
a	Linear model coefficient	14
b	Linear model offset	14
N	Number of observations	14
$\mathbf{x}$	Vector of observations	14
$\mathbf{A}$	Linear transformation matrix	14
ε	Residual error	14

Notation and command reference

Registered variables are in the preceding List of Symbols. This page describes general mathematical conventions and the remaining public helpers. Use `MathOperators.tex` to adjust these definitions consistently.

Mathematical helpers

Command	Meaning or rendered convention
`\func{f}{X}{Y}`	$f\colon X \to Y$, a function signature.
`\norm{x}{p}`	$\|x\|_p$; empty second argument omits the index.
`\Abs{x}`	$\lvert x\rvert$, absolute value.
`\Set{x}{P(x)}`	$\{x \mid P(x)\}$, set-builder notation.
`\ctrans{a}`, `\dtrans`	$p \xrightarrow{a} q$, $p \xrightarrow{*} q$, labelled and starred arrows.
`\argmin`, `\argmax`	$\operatorname{argmin}_x f(x)$, $\operatorname{argmax}_x f(x)$; limits-style operators.
`\diag`, `\Tr`	$\operatorname{diag}(A)$, $\operatorname{tr}(A)$; diagonal and trace.
`\Span`, `\Ker`, `\Ran`	$\operatorname{span}(S)$, $\ker(A)$, $\operatorname{ran}(A)$; span, kernel and range.
`\Dom`, `\supp`	$\operatorname{dom}(f)$, $\operatorname{supp}(f)$; domain and support.
`\Sign`, `\abs`	$\operatorname{sign}(x)$, $\mathbf{abs}(x)$; sign and bold entrywise absolute-value operator.
`\Lip`, `\Aggr`	$\operatorname{Lip}(f)$, $\operatorname{Aggr}(S)$; inherited upright operator names. Define their mathematical meaning in your text.
`\Skew`, `\Prod`	$\operatorname{skew}(A)$, $\operatorname{prod}(S)$; named operators, not the large product symbol $\prod$.
`\Vol`, `\Aff`, `\Conv`	$\operatorname{vol}(S)$, $\operatorname{aff}(S)$, $\operatorname{conv}(S)$; volume, affine hull and convex hull.
`\Int`, `\Cl`	$\operatorname{int}(S)$, $\operatorname{cl}(S)$; interior and closure.

Command	Meaning or rendered convention
`\Aconv`	$\mathrm{dconv}(S)$; the inherited command prints dconv. Change or explain that convention before using it.
`\Orth{n}`, `\So{n}`	$\mathrm{O}(n)$, $\mathrm{SO}(n)$; orthogonal and special orthogonal groups.

The delimiter helpers accept an optional explicit size as shown in chapter 4. Their underlying `ThesisNormDelimiter`, `ThesisAbsDelimiter` and `ThesisSetDelimiter` commands are `mathtools` paired delimiters. Prefer the documented wrappers so the legacy argument order remains consistent.

Layout helper index

Helper	Where it is explained
`\MyThesis`, `\MyDefense`	Shared metadata, chapter 2.
`\FigLocation`, `\ChapLocation`	Chapter-relative path prefixes, chapter 7.
`\DeclareThesisSymbol`, `\mathsymbols`	Symbol declarations, chapter 4.
`\PrintThesisSymbols`	Global list output, chapter 7.
`\pubfootnote`, `\myfootnote`	Publication and ordinary notes, chapter 5.
`\LineComment`	Algorithm comment, chapter 3.
`absbox`, `theorem`, `definition`, `proposition`	Chapter summaries and mathematical boxes, Chapters 4 and 6.
`\ThumbColor`, `\absColor`	Main colour and tint per chapter, chapter 6.
`\ColorTheme`, `\NumberChapterColor`	Current and opening-number colour, chapter 6.
`\HeadingColor`, `\TitleColor`, `\SectionColor`	Heading accents, chapter 6.
`\PageNumberStyle`, `\minsize`, `\myfontsize`	Page-number shape and text, chapter 6.
`\myfont`, `\myfontconfig`	Typeface and shared weight, chapter 6.
`\ThesisChapterCount`, `\ThesisThumbsfalse`	Marker spacing and visibility, chapter 6.

Helper	Where it is explained
`mypagestyle`, `notationstyle`, `plain`	Main pages, front/back matter and chapter-opening pages.

The retained `\ThumbColIdx`, `\titlestyle` and `ThumbEnd` definitions belong to earlier design variants and are not used by the active page styles. Editing them will not change the current design. The `abstract` environment's run-in formatting is also retained; the example front summaries use unnumbered chapters and chapter summaries use `absbox`.

Bibliography

[Thea] The biblatex maintainers. *The biblatex Package Documentation*. `https://ctan.org/pkg/biblatex`. Use the manual supplied with your installed version (cit. on p. 21).

[Theb] The memoir maintainers. *The memoir Class Manual*. `https://ctan.org/pkg/memoir`. Use the manual supplied with your installed version (cit. on p. 20).

[Uni26a] University of Twente. *Doctoral Regulations*. `https://www.utwente.nl/en/education/tgs/downloads-forms/phd-downloads/ut-doctoral-regulations.pdf`. Effective 1 January 2026. Articles 13, 15, 16 and 19; Annexes 3 and 4. Accessed 21 October 2026. 2026 (cit. on pp. 6–8).

[Uni26b] University of Twente. *Doctorate: PhD and EngD Monitoring System*. `https://www.utwente.nl/en/service-portal/research-support/phd-engd-programmes-tgs/doctorate-phdengd-monitoring-system`. PhD candidate graduation workflow. Accessed 21 October 2026. 2026 (cit. on p. 6).

Publications

[Mor26] Alex Morgan. *Example Supplementary Research Materials*. Fictional example, included with an explicit nocite command. 2026.

[MT26] Alex Morgan and Jordan Taylor. "An Example Publication for This Template". In: *Example Journal* 1 (2026). Fictional example; replace before submission, pp. 1–8 (cit. on pp. 19, 20).

A place for your research

This layout keeps each chapter beside its figures and uses consistent colours, symbols and references throughout the thesis. The example chapters explain how to replace their content with your own work.

Replace this paragraph with a short description for readers encountering your thesis for the first time. Edit this file to change the back cover.

Marcio L. Lima de Oliveira

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